

ENGLISH, POWER, ACCESS

Vikings, Normans, English

CONTACT CHANGED ENGLISH

03 / 12



Two contacts, different power

NORSE CONTACT

Neighbours

Settlement expanded.

Daily speech mixed.

NORMAN RULE

Rulers

Conquest changed elites.

French gained prestige.

Contact was unequal.

Norse entered daily speech

they

sky

law

take

egg

window

WHY IT MATTERS

**Ordinary words
crossed
languages.**

Contact reached daily
life.

Gersum tracks Norse words.

Grammar also became lighter

01

Endings weakened

Forms became fewer.

02

Order mattered

Position carried meaning.

03

Contact helped

Its weight stays debated.

Norse alone caused everything.

UNPROVEN

1066 changed elite language

ENGLISH

Local speech

FRENCH

Norman officials

LATIN

Official records

Domesday shows this hierarchy.

French filled powerful domains

LAW

**court · judge ·
prison**

Institutions spread
words.

RULE

**government ·
parliament**

Institutions spread
words.

STATUS

**noble · royal ·
servant**

Institutions spread
words.

Borrowing followed power.

English survived and mixed

800s

1066

1200s+



Norse
contact

Norman
conquest

Middle
English

English was never replaced.

No single switch occurred.

Sources and limits

Gersum Project

Norse word evidence

Warner, 2017

Grammar contact debate

National Archives

Domesday languages

Anglo-Norman Dictionary

French source records

EVIDENCE

INFERENCE

UNPROVEN

NEXT: Printing and standards